

Rainbow's End

A NOVEL.

BY REX BEACH

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"The Iron Trail," "The Spoilers"
"Heart of the Sunset," etc.

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Johnnie expressed his gratitude for this ready assistance. "One thing more," said he. "Will you give me a boy, Jack, a new pair of trousers and send him back to the Orient at the first opportunity?"

"Of course. It is done." The general laid a friendly hand upon O'Reilly's shoulder, saying, gravely: "It would relieve me intensely to send you back with him, for I have fears for the success of your venture. Matanzas is a hell; it has swallowed up thousands of our good countrymen; thousands have died there. I'm afraid you do not realize what risks you are taking."

O'Reilly did not allow this well-meant warning to influence him, nor did he listen to the admonitions of those other Cubans who tried to argue with him out of his purpose, once it became known. On the contrary, he proceeded with his preparations and spent that afternoon in satisfying himself that Ross had indeed left the Pan de Matanzas before O'Reilly's raid.

Among Betancourt's troops was a man who had been living in the hills at the time Asensio and his family had abandoned their struggle for existence, and to him O'Reilly went. This fellow, it seemed, had remained with his family in the mountains some time after Asensio's departure. It was from him that O'Reilly heard his first authentic report of the atrocities perpetrated by Cobo's volunteers. This man had lost his wife, his little son, and all the scanty belongings he possessed. With shaking hands upstretched to heaven, the fellow cursed the author of his misfortunes.

"I live for one thing!" he cried shrilly—"to meet that monster, and to butcher him, as he butchers women and children."

O'Reilly purposely left his most unpleasant task to the last. When his arrangements had been completed and he had acquainted himself as far as possible with the hazards he was likely to encounter, he took Jack aside and broke the news to him that on the following morning they must part. As he had expected, the boy refused to listen to him. O'Reilly remained firm and Jack began to weep copiously. He worked himself up to a hysterical crescendo which threatened to arouse the entire encampment. But O'Reilly was unmoved.

"Be quiet," he told the boy. "I won't let you go with me, and that ends it. It will be hard enough for one man to slip through; two would be sure to fail."

"Those Spaniards will kill you!" Jack wailed.

"So much the more reason for you to stay here."

At this the boy uttered a louder cry. He stamped his bare feet in a frenzy of disappointment. "You dasent leave me—you dasent!"

"Listen, people are starving in Matanzas; they are sick; they are dying in the streets."

"I don't eat much."

When Johnnie shook his head stubbornly Jack launched himself into a torrent of profanity the violence of which dried his tears. His vocabulary was surprising. He reviled the Spaniards, O'Reilly, himself, everybody and everything; he leveled anathemas at that woman who had come between him and his beloved benefactor. The latter listened good-naturedly.

"You're a tough kid," he laughed, when Jack's first rage had worn itself out. "I like you, and I'd take you

was, without doubt, unequalled in any country. He was a veritable Spartan, too, when it came to hardship—privation and suffering were almost to his liking. He was discreet—discretion was something he had inherited; he was a diplomat—diplomacy being one of his most unique accomplishments. As for this talk about hunger, O'Reilly need not concern himself in the least on that score, for Jack was a small eater and could grow fat on a diet of dried leaves. Dismiss! Bahl! It made him laugh. His experience with sickness was wider than most sailors, and he was a better nurse than Miss Evers would ever be. Jack did not wish to appear in the least boastful. On the contrary, he was actually too modest, as his friends could attest, but truth compelled him to admit that he was just the man for O'Reilly. He found it impossible to recommend him self too highly; to save his soul he could think of no qualification in which he was lacking and could see no reason why his benefactor would not greatly profit by the free use of his amazing talents. The enterprise was difficult; it would certainly fail with out him.

Johnnie remained carefully attentive during this adjuration. He felt no desire even to smile, for the boy's earnestness was touching and it caused the elder man's throat to tighten uncomfortably. Johnnie had not realized before how fond he had become of this quaint youngster. And so, when the little fellow paused hopefully, O'Reilly put an arm around him.

"I'm sure you are everything you say you are, Jack, and more, too, but you can't go!"

With that Jack flung off the embrace and, stalking away, seated himself. He took a half-smoked cigar from the pocket of his shirt and lit it, scowling the while at his friend. More than once during the evening O'Reilly detected his sullen, angry eyes upon him.

General Betancourt and several members of his staff were up early the following morning to bid their visitor good-by. In spite of their efforts to make the parting cheerful it was plain that they had but little hope of ever again seeing this footloose American.

Johnnie's spirits were not in the least affected by this ill-concealed pessimism, for, as he told himself, he had money in his pockets and Matanzas was not many miles away. But when he came to part from Jack he experienced a genuine disappointment. The boy, strangely enough, was almost indifferent to his leaving; he merely extended a limp, dirty hand, and replied to O'Reilly's parting words with a careless "Adios!"

In hurt surprise the former inquired, "Don't we part good friends?"

"Sure!" Jack shrugged, then turned away.

Jack was a likable youngster; his devotion was thoroughly unselfish; it had not been easy to wound him. With keener regrets than he cared to acknowledge O'Reilly set out upon his journey, following the guide whom General Betancourt had provided.

It was a lovely morning, sufficiently warm to promise a hot midday; the air was moist and fresh from a recent shower. This being the rainy season, the trails were soft, and where the rich red Cuban soil was exposed the travelers sank into it as into wet putty.

Crossing a rocky ridge, O'Reilly and his guide at last emerged upon an open slope, knee-high in grass and grown up to bottle palms, those queer, distorted trees whose trunks are swollen into the likeness of earthen water jars. Scattered here and there over the meadows were the dead or fallen trunks of another variety, the cabbage palm, the green heart of which had long formed a staple article of diet for the insurgents. Spanish axes had been at work here and not a single tree remained alive. The green floor of the valley farther down was dotted with the other, the royal kind, that monarch of tropic vegetation which lends to the Cuban landscape its peculiar and distinctive beauty.

"Yonder is the camino," said the countryman, pointing into the valley; "it will lead you to the main road; and there"—he turned to the northward—"is Matanzas. Go with God, and don't drink the well water, which is polluted from the rains." With a smile and a wave of the hand the man turned back and plunged into the jungle.

As O'Reilly descended the slope he realized keenly that he was alone and in hostile territory. The hills and the woods from Pinar del Rio to Oriente were Cuban, or, at most, they were disputed ground. But here in the plains and valleys near the cities Spain was supreme. From this moment on O'Reilly knew he must rely entirely upon himself. The success of his enterprise—his very life—hinged upon his caution, his powers of dissimulation, his ability to pass as a harmless, helpless pacifist. It gave him an unaccustomed thrill, by no means pleasant.

The road, when he came to it, proved to be a deep gutter winding between red clay banks cut by the high wheels of clumsy cane carts. Inasmuch as no crops whatever had been moved over the road during the past season, it was now little more than an oozy, sticky rut. Not a roof, not a chimney was in sight; the valley was deserted. Here was a fertile farming country—and yet no living thing, no sound of bells, no voices, no crowing cocks, no lowing cattle. It was depressing to O'Reilly, and more, for there was something menacing and threatening about it all.

Toward noon the breeze lessened and it became insufferably hot. A bank of clouds in the east promised a cooling shower, so Johnnie sought the nearest shade to wait for it, and took advantage of the delay to eat his slender lunch. He was meditatively munching a sweet potato when a sound at his back caused him to leap to his feet in alarm. He whirled, then uttered an exclamation of amazement. Seated not fifty feet away was a bare-legged boy, similarly engaged in eating a sweet potato. It was Jack. His brown cheeks were distended, his bright, inquisitive eyes were fixed upon O'Reilly from beneath a defiant scowl.

"Jack!" cried the man. "What the devil are you doing here?"

"You goin' to let me come along?"

"So! You followed me, after I said I didn't want you?" O'Reilly spoke reproachfully; but reproaches had no effect upon the lad. With a mild ex-

pressive, Jack signified his contempt for such a weak form of persuasion.

"See here, now," O'Reilly stopped closer. "Let's be sensible about this." But Jack scrambled to his feet and retreated warily, stuffing the uneaten portion of the sweet potato into his mouth. It was plain that he had no confidence in O'Reilly's intentions. Muttering something in a muffled voice, he armed himself with a stout stick.

"Come here," commanded the American.

Jack shook his head. He made a painful attempt to swallow, and when his utterance became more distinct he consigned his stick to a warmer place than Cuba.

"I'm a tough kid," he declared.

"Don't get gay on me."

The two parleyed briefly; then, when satisfied that no violence was intended him, the boy sat down to listen. But, as before, neither argument nor appeal had the slightest effect upon him. He denied that he had followed his benefactor; he declared that he was a free agent and at liberty to go where he willed. If it so chanced that his fancy took him to the city of Matanzas, at the same time O'Reilly happened to be traveling thither, the circumstance might be put down to the long arm of coincidence. If his company were distasteful to the elder man, O'Reilly was free to wait and follow later; it was a matter of complete indifference to Jack. He had business in Matanzas and he proposed to attend to it. The boy lied gravely, unblushingly. Nevertheless, he kept a watchful eye upon his hearer.

"Very well," O'Reilly told him finally. "I give in."

Jack's face instantly lit up. He radiated good humor; he hitched his body closer.

"By—! I get my own way, don't I?" he laughed.

"Indeed you do," O'Reilly laid a hand fondly upon his loyal follower.

"And I don't mind telling you that I'm more than half glad of it. I—I was getting lonesome. I didn't know how much I could miss you. But now we must make some plans, we must have an understanding and decide who we are. Let me see—your real name is Narciso—"

"Narciso Villar."

"Well, then, I shall be Juan Villar, your brother. Henceforth we shall speak nothing but Spanish. Tell me now, what was our father's name, where was our home, and what are we doing together?"

During the breathless interval before the shower the two sat with their heads together, talking earnestly. As the wind came and the cooling rain began to rattle on the leaves overhead they took up their bundles and set out. The big drops drenched them quickly. Their thin garments clung to them and water streamed down their bodies; overhead the sky was black and rent by vivid streaks of fire, but they plodded onward cheerfully.

Jack was himself again; he bent his weight against the tempest and lengthened his short strides to O'Reilly's. He tried to whistle, but his teeth chattered and the wind interfered, so he hummed a song, to drive the chill out of his bones and to lighten his benefactor. Now that he was at last accepted as a full partner in this enterprise, it became his duty not only to share its perils, but to lessen its hardships and to yield diversion.

The rain was cold, the briars beside the overgrown path were sharp, and they scratched the boy's bare legs cruelly; his stomach clamored for a companion to that solitary sweet potato, too, but in his breast glowed ardor and pride. Jack considered himself a fortunate person—a very fortunate person, indeed. Had he not found a brother, and did not that brother love him? There was no doubt about the latter, for O'Reilly's eyes, when he looked down, were friendly and intimate. Here was a man to die for.

The downpour lasted but a short time, when the sun came out and dried the man's clothes; on the whole, it had been refreshing. When evening came the Villar brothers sought refuge in an old sugar mill, or rather in a part of it still standing. They were on the main calzada now, the paved road which links the two main cities of the island, and by the following noon their destination was in sight.

O'Reilly felt a sudden excitement when Matanzas came into view. From this distance the city looked quite as it did when he had left it, except that the blue harbor was almost empty of shipping, while the familiar range of hills that hid the Yumuri—that valley of delight so closely linked in his thoughts with Rosa Varona—seemed to smile at him like an old friend. For the thousandth time he asked himself if he had come in time to find her, or if fate's maddening delays had proved his own and the girl's undoing.

O'Reilly knew that although Matanzas was a prison and a pesthole, a girl like Rosa would suffer in perils infinitely worse than imprisonment or disease. It was a thought he could not bear to dwell upon.

Signs of life began to appear now, the travelers passed small garden patches and occasional cultivated fields; they encountered lording carts bound into the city, and once they hid themselves while a column of mounted troops went by.

O'Reilly stopped to pass the time of day with a wrinkled cartman whose dejected oxen were resting.

"Going into the city, are you?" the fellow inquired. "Starved out, I suppose. Well, it's as pleasant to starve in one place as another."

Jack helped himself to a stalk of cane from the load and began to strip it with his teeth.

"Will the soldiers allow us to enter?" Johnnie inquired.

"Of course. Why not? The old man laughed mirthlessly; then his voice changed. "Go back," he said, "go back and die in the fields. Matanzas stinks of rotting corpses. Go back where the air is clean." He swung his long lash over the oxen, they leaned against the load, and the cart creaked dully on its way.

It is never difficult to enter a trap, and Matanzas was precisely that. There were soldiers everywhere, but beyond an indifferent challenge at the outer blockhouse, a perfunctory question or two, Narciso and Juan Villar experienced no trouble whatever in passing the lines. Discipline, never

strict at best, was extremely lax at the brick fortifications along the roads, and since these two refugees were too poor to warrant search, they were waved onward by the sentries. They obeyed silently, in aimless bewilderment they shuffled along toward the heart of the city. Almost before they realized it they had run the gauntlet and had joined that army of misery, fifteen thousand strong. The hand of Spain had closed over them.

(Continued in next issue).

DISASTROUS FIRE IN SEATTLE WAS CAUSED BY CIGARETTE STUB

SEATTLE, Aug. 7.—Fire, believed to have been caused by a cigarette, destroyed last night the mill of the Russell Lumber company adjoining the southern city limits, and a stock of lumber, the total loss being estimated at \$305,000. Half of the loss, it was said, was covered by insurance. Nearly \$3,000,000 worth of supplies belonging to the Russian commission, nearby, were endangered for a time. Apparatus from the Seattle fire department assisted employees in fighting the flames. Three freight cars also were destroyed.

COLUMBIA HIGHWAY CLOSED TO TRAFFIC AT CASCADE LOCKS

PORTLAND, Aug. 12.—According to a telephone message received today by S. Benson, chairman of the state highway commission, paving work will begin Wednesday between Cascade Locks and the Multnomah county line, and in consequence the Columbia river highway will be closed at that point. An alternate route will be from Vancouver over the North Bank road, crossing back on to the Oregon side by ferry at Cascade Locks or White Salmon.

\$100,000 INCREASE IN PROFITS IS SHOWN

SALEM, Aug. 12.—In spite of increased wages and increased cost of material the Pacific Telephone & Telegraph company, thanks to a very material increase in operating revenues, showed more than \$100,000 in the good in the game of increases on its lines in Oregon during 1918, according to the report of the company on file in the office of the state public service commission here.

MAN GUILTY OF BOMB OUTRAGE IS SUICIDE WHEN APPREHENDED

LOS ANGELES, Cal., Aug. 7.—With the mystery of the bombing of the home of former United States Assistant Attorney General Oscar Lawler solved by the suicide shortly before midnight last night of Charles H. McGwire, assistant chief engineer for the Los Angeles board of public utilities, the police were endeavoring to determine today whether anyone else was implicated in the destruction of the Lawler home except McGwire.

McGwire leaped to his death from the office of District Attorney Thomas Lee Woolwine, eleventh floor of the Hall of Records, last night when confronted with evidence that he placed the bomb and told that Woolwine would call a special session of the county grand jury to ask for his indictment.

GENERAL DECREASE IN PRICES NOW NOTED

CHICAGO, Aug. 12.—Effects of the nation's fight against the high cost of living has been felt here. The first blow against the profiteers was struck when an order was issued setting the price of 12 cents a pound as a fair one for sugar, and a second one was the sale of 60,000 cans of vegetables, the first Chicago sale of government foods, at two loop department stores. Those who purchased the goods saved 8 cents on each can, or about 50 per cent.

Prices asked for fruits and produce along "commission row" went tumbling, potatoes leading the downward trend. They fell from 50 cents to 11 per hundred pounds. The arrival of many peaches from southern and western states caused a drop in prices.

FEDERAL PLANES FOR FOREST PATROL ARE ASSEMBLED AT MEDFORD

MEDFORD, Aug. 7.—The entire federal aviation fire patrol service for Oregon was assembled in the state for the first time last night, when six army airplanes arrived here unannounced at 7 o'clock, having flown Wednesday afternoon from Mather field, Sacramento, to join Lieutenant Kiehl and Sergeant McKee, who flew here from Eugene and Roseburg and arrived at about 3:30 o'clock.

OLD BATTLESHIP OREGON WILL GO ON FINAL CALL

BREMERTON, Wash., Aug. 7.—So that the famous old battleship Oregon, once pride of the American navy, can steam from Bremerton to San Francisco to participate in the welcome to the Pacific fleet there, work costing \$150,000 must be done on the warship, it was learned at the Puget sound navy yard today.

Orders to put the Oregon back into full commission came recently. Only six weeks ago most of the warship's motive gear, including the dynamos, was removed, preparatory to towing the vessel in to Portland, where the navy bulldog of Spanish-American war days was to be a training ship for the Oregon naval reserve.

A large force of men is working day and night so that the battleship will reach San Francisco by August 31. Much of the equipment taken out of the vessel was obsolete and must be replaced.

ROYALIST PARTY GAINS CONTROL; PREMIER OUSTED

PARIS, Aug. 7.—Julius Poldi, premier of the new Hungarian government, has been overthrown, the peace conference was advised today. The report stated that Archduke Joseph has established a government.

The coup d'etat by which Poldi was overthrown was carried out by the Hungarian police, it was said. There was no disorder. The police arrested the members of the cabinet while they were holding a session.

It was held by the peace conference today that the Roumanian ultimatum to the Hungarians, demanding surrender of materials, upsets the reparation terms of the Austrian treaty.

GOVERNMENT WILL LIMIT PROFIT ON FLOUR BY DEALERS

NEW YORK, Aug. 9.—Details of the United States Grain corporation's plan to sell flour at \$10 a barrel were made public today by Julius H. Barnes, United States wheat director. Restrictions are placed on the price to be charged by wholesalers, jobbers and retailers.

The flour will be sold in sacks on a basis of \$10 in the territory west of the Illinois and Indiana line and west of the Mississippi from Cairo to the Gulf of Mexico, not including the Pacific Coast region, and at \$10.25 in the remainder of the country.

PORTLAND ATTORNEY ADVISES PHONE USERS NOT TO PAY NEW RATES

PORTLAND, Aug. 7.—After an exhaustive study of the telephone situation, Chief Deputy City Attorney Tomlinson Wednesday issued an opinion advising telephone users to refuse to pay the new rates the company is attempting to collect.

"These rates are not lawful," says Tomlinson, "and the company is certainly taking a high-handed stand when it tries to foist them on the public. Company officials claim that the new rates were ordered by Postmaster General Hurleston, but they have not been able to produce any such order."

Tomlinson says subscribers may, if they so desire, tender payment of bills to the company on the old pre-war schedule, but even this is not necessary.

Meantime the telephone company is swamped with orders from all parts of the city to have phones taken out.

City Traffic Expert E. M. Cousin ended his term of service with the city Wednesday morning. He strongly advises the public not to pay any bills until the lawful rate is definitely established. Cousin goes back to his private business as traffic attorney in the Railway Exchange building.

BIG SUGAR COMBINE IS FORMED BY FIVE BIG MANUFACTURERS

NEW YORK, Aug. 7.—The United States Food Products corporation announced yesterday that it had purchased the Sugar Products company, the Pure Cane Molasses company of the United States, the Pure Cane Molasses company of Canada, the British Molasses company of Great Britain and the Tres company, Limited, of Great Britain. The entire purchase price was said to have been paid in cash. The United States Food Products corporation was formerly the Distillers' Securities corporation and is engaged in the manufacture of industrial alcohol and livestock feed, in the latter of which molasses forms an important ingredient.

At funerals during the 18th century all sorts of liquors were served. Finally, largely because the intoxication of mourners appeared unseemly, the custom was abandoned. This innovation was greatly deplored by some resolute toppers, and one of them remarked bitterly that "Temperance has done for funerals."



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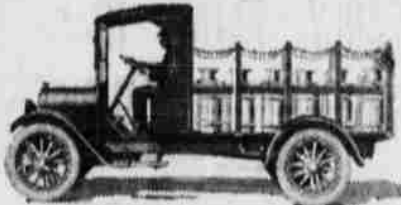
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"You're a Tough Kid!" He Laughed.

If I could. But this isn't an enterprise for a boy, and it won't get you anything to keep up this racket."

Jack tried the power of argument. He attempted to prove that in a hazardous undertaking of this sort his assistance would be invaluable. He was, so he declared, the one person in all Cuba in every respect qualified to share O'Reilly's perils. To begin with, he was not afraid of Spaniards, or anything else, for that matter—he dismissed the subject of personal courage with a contemptuous shrug. As for cunning, sagacity, prudence, resource, all-around worth, he